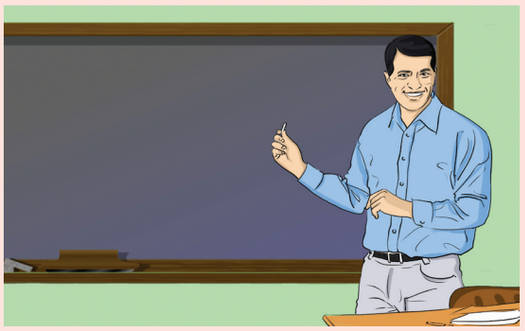
Activity: Conversation on Cauvery Dispute





Student: Sir, can you please explain us the Cauvery dispute?

Teacher: Cauvery dispute is an inter-State water dispute. It involves the states of Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Kerala and Union Territory of Puducherry.

Student: What is the history behind the issue?

Teacher: The history of the issue is a long one. The Madras Presidency and the Princely State of Mysore signed an agreement in 1924 for sharing the waters. After being in operation for fifty years the agreement lapsed in 1974.

Student: Did the disputants hold negotiations thereafter?

Teacher: Yes, many rounds of negotiations were conducted for nearly two decades but no solution was reached. As we learnt earlier in the class, the Inter State River Water Disputes Act 1956 allows for the formation of a tribunal for resolving the river water disputes. The Cauvery River Water Tribunal was established in 1991 to solve the issue.

Student: Did the Tribunal deliver its Award? What are the features of its Award?

Teacher: Yes. The Tribunal gave the final Award in 2007. It stipulated a monthly release of water from Karnataka to Tamil Nadu across the border in Biligundlu. It fixed the share of each state from Cauvery River. It provided a distress formula to share the waters in years when rainfall is low allowing for proportionate sharing of the available water.

Student: What is the Cauvery management Board?

Teacher: The Tribunal provided a Cauvery Water Management Board to manage the tricky problem of sharing the water

Student: Has it been formed?

Teacher: After many years of litigation, the Supreme Court delivered the final verdict and directed the Union Government to constitute the mechanism to implement the Award. The Cauvery Water Management Authority and the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee were established in 2018 to

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